

Thank you, Claude

Your answers are recorded.

Developing

Your Fractional CPO practice is still developing the infrastructure needed to make your expertise repeatable across clients.

You may have strong approaches in some areas while relying on experience and improvisation in others. That can work—particularly when you're dealing with situations you've seen before—but it also means each new engagement may require more preparation, custom materials, and reinvention than it should.

The goal isn't to standardize your judgment. It's to standardize the things surrounding your judgment so you can spend more of your time diagnosing problems, coaching leaders, facilitating decisions, and helping organizations change.

YOUR PRACTICE PROFILE

DIAGNOSE

Systematic



Quickly understand what's really happening inside a client's product organization.

ALIGN

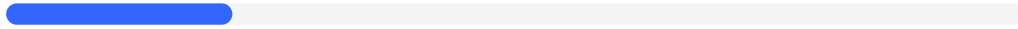
Established



Turn diagnosis into shared understanding, priorities, and decisions.

ENABLE

Ad hoc



Help the organization develop the capabilities it needs without rebuilding everything yourself.

DEMONSTRATE

Established



Make improvement visible and create a natural path for continuing the engagement.

SCALE

Established



Build a consulting practice that doesn't require you to reinvent your approach for every client.

YOUR STRONGEST AREA**DIAGNOSE**

You have a consistent way to get inside a new organization and turn vague concerns into specific problems. That gives your engagements an evidence-based starting point rather than relying entirely on interviews, intuition, and whatever problem the loudest executive identified first.

YOUR GREATEST LEVERAGE OPPORTUNITY

ENABLE

Capability gaps are creating production work for you. Reusable workshops, exercises, learning materials, and coaching resources could reduce preparation time and let you focus more of your effort on interpretation, coaching, and change.

WHAT YOU SAID

DIAGNOSE

1 Repeatable Diagnosis

I have a repeatable way to assess how a new client's product organization is operating.

Your answer: **Consistently**

WHY THIS MATTERS

Most engagements begin with whatever the client happened to say in the first conversation, which means the starting point moves with the mood of the room. A repeatable assessment gives you the same starting point every time, and it gives the client something they can see for themselves rather than a conclusion they have to take on trust.

2 From Concern to Problem

I can turn a broad concern such as “product isn't working” into a specific set of problems that can be examined and prioritized.

Your answer: **Consistently**

WHY THIS MATTERS

“Product isn't working” is a feeling, and nobody can prioritize a feeling. The work is turning it into a short list of specific problems with names and owners, because that is the first point at which a leadership team can disagree with you productively.

3 Breadth of Diagnosis

My diagnostic approach examines more than process—it helps me identify gaps in execution, ownership, skills, and organizational capability.

Your answer: **Usually**

WHY THIS MATTERS

Process is the easiest thing to look at and the least likely to be the whole answer. A diagnosis that stops there tends to prescribe ceremonies for problems that were really about who owns what, who knows how, and whether anyone has the time.

ALIGN

4 Executive Readout

I can present my findings in a form that helps executives and product leaders discuss the problems constructively.

Your answer: **Usually**

WHY THIS MATTERS

Findings that are clear to you are not automatically discussable by a group, and a readout that lands like a verdict invites defence rather than decisions. The form matters as much as the content: evidence people can see the basis of gets argued with differently from an opinion delivered with authority.

5 Facilitating Decisions

I have repeatable ways to facilitate decisions about what needs to change, what matters most, and who should own it.

Your answer: **Usually**

WHY THIS MATTERS

Agreeing that something is a problem is the cheap half. The expensive half is a room deciding what to do first and who owns it, and that rarely happens on its own—it happens because somebody ran a structure designed to produce a decision.

6 Prioritized Improvements

My engagements move clients from general concerns to a short list of specific, prioritized improvements.

Your answer: **Consistently**

WHY THIS MATTERS

The test of a diagnosis is what the client can act on the week after you present it. A short prioritized list is the artefact that survives the engagement; a comprehensive assessment carrying thirty findings usually does not.

ENABLE

7 Ready Learning Materials

When I identify a capability gap, I have learning or coaching materials I can use without creating them from scratch.

Your answer: **Never**

WHY THIS MATTERS

Finding a capability gap creates an obligation, and when the only way to meet it is to build a curriculum, the gap tends to get quietly downgraded to a recommendation. Having something ready is what lets you treat a skills gap as seriously as a process gap.

8 Reusable Workshops

I have reusable workshops, exercises, and facilitation materials that can be adapted to different clients.

Your answer: **Rarely**

WHY THIS MATTERS

Adapting a workshop takes an hour; building one takes a week. That difference decides whether a facilitated session is something you offer whenever it would help, or something you have to talk yourself into.

9 Preparation Time

I spend most of my preparation time understanding the client's situation rather than building slides, spreadsheets, exercises, or training materials.

Your answer: **Rarely**

WHY THIS MATTERS

Preparation time is the scarcest thing in a fractional practice, and production work is what usually eats it. Where that time actually goes is the most honest measure of how much infrastructure you have.

DEMONSTRATE

10 Baseline at the Start

At the beginning of an engagement, I establish a baseline that can be used to evaluate improvement later.

Your answer: **Usually**

WHY THIS MATTERS

A baseline costs almost nothing at the start of an engagement and cannot be recovered afterwards. Without one, the case for what your work achieved rests on everyone's memory of how bad things were, and those memories tend to improve over time.

11 Reassessment

I have a repeatable way to reassess a client and show what has—and hasn't—improved.

Your answer: **Rarely**

WHY THIS MATTERS

Reassessment only means something if it asks the same questions the same way, which is why it depends on the diagnosis having been repeatable in the first place. It is also the most natural reason for a client to continue working with you, and it does not require you to ask.

12 Evidence for What's Next

The results of my work make it easier to have an evidence-based conversation about what the client should address next.

Your answer: **Consistently**

WHY THIS MATTERS

Every engagement ends with a question about what comes next, and it is usually answered with opinion. Evidence changes the character of that conversation from a pitch into a reading of where things now stand.

SCALE

13 Reusable Methods

The methods, tools, and materials I use can be reused across clients with reasonable customization.

Your answer: **Consistently**

WHY THIS MATTERS

Reuse is not standardization: the judgement stays bespoke, and the machinery around it does not have to be. The practical question is how much of your last engagement you could carry into the next one without apologising for it.

14 Rights to Your IP

I have the rights to use the intellectual property, frameworks, and materials on which my consulting practice depends.

Your answer: **Usually**

WHY THIS MATTERS

Plenty of independent practices run on frameworks and materials that came from somewhere else, and the question of who owns them only gets asked when something is at stake. It is worth knowing the answer before a client's legal team asks it.

15 Peers to Call

When I encounter a difficult client situation I haven't seen before, I have experienced product leaders I can turn to for perspective and advice.

Your answer: **Rarely**

WHY THIS MATTERS

Independence removes the colleague you used to check a read with on the way out of a meeting. Replacing that deliberately is infrastructure too, even though it looks like a social arrangement rather than a tool.

Want more leverage from your practice?

You just experienced one of the ideas behind Quartz Assessments.
Instead of starting with advice, start with evidence.

Quartz Product Leadership was built for experienced product leaders who want to make their consulting practices more repeatable without making them formulaic.

You bring the experience. Quartz brings the infrastructure: assessments, a Product Operating Model, facilitation materials, learning programs, and a community of experienced practitioners.

See how Quartz could support your Fractional CPO practice →
www.productgrowthleaders.com/program/fractional-product-leadership

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